SCHOLASTIC SCOPE

Apostrophes
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Name: _____ **Date:** _____

Do You Need That Apostrophe?

You have a word that ends with *s*. Should there be an apostrophe before that *s*? Here's what you need to know:

A DO NOT use apostrophes to form plurals.

1. The plural form of a noun indicates more than one person, place, or thing. Plural nouns usually end in *s*. For example: *shoes, apples, faces*. So . . .

NO: Leave your umbrella's by the door.

YES: Leave your umbrellas by the door.

2. Irregular plural nouns, like *men*, *women*, *feet*, and *mice* have no *s*, and they need no *s*! So . . .

NO: The children's are upstairs.

YES: The children are upstairs.

3. To form the plural of a singular noun that ends in a consonant followed by *y*, remove the final *y* and replace it with *ies*. For example: *party* becomes *parties, body* becomes *bodies*, and *baby* becomes *babies*. So . . .

NO: Two lady's showed us to our seats.

YES: Two ladies showed us to our seats.

B DO NOT use apostrophes to form possessive pronouns.

A possessive pronoun is a word that shows ownership, like *hers, ours, whose,* and *its*. So . . .

NO: The book is her's.

YES: The book is hers.

NO: That pen is missing it's cap.

YES: That pen is missing its cap.

C DO use apostrophes to form possessives.

Possessives show ownership.

1. To make a singular noun (like *dog*) possessive, add *'s* to the end. So . . .

YES: The dog's ball is red.

Add *'s* even if the noun ends with *s*. So . . .

YES: Where is James's guitar?

2. To make a compound noun (a noun formed by two or more words) possessive, add *'s* to the end of the last word. So . . .

YES: I met my sister-in-law's baby.

YES: The movie star's car is fast.

3. If two or more people or things possess or share the same item, add *'s* to the last person or thing only. So . . .

YES: Karen and Walter's house is beautiful.

4. To make a plural noun (like *kids*) possessive, add an apostrophe after the *s* that is already at the end of the word. If the plural noun is irregular and doesn't end in *s*, add an apostrophe and an *s*. So . . .

YES: The kids' toy needs to be washed.
This refers to one toy shared by two or more kids.

YES: The women's hats are in the closet.

An activity on apostrophe *s* begins on the next page.

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Directions: Fill in the circle next to the correct answer to each question.

1. Choose the sentence that is punctuated correctly.
Ⓐ Gerald's vegetable's were overcooked.
Ⓑ Geralds vegetables were overcooked.
Ⓒ Gerald's vegetables were overcooked.
Ⓓ Geralds' vegetables were overcooked.

2. Which of the following correctly indicates that the expensive camera belongs to Ross?
Ⓐ Ross's camera is expensive.
Ⓑ Ross camera is expensive.
Ⓒ Ros's camera is expensive.
Ⓓ Rosses camera is expensive.

3. Read this sentence:
Rob and Anna's kids' tree house is amazing.
To whom does the tree house belong?
Ⓐ one kid
Ⓑ Anna
Ⓒ more than one kid
Ⓓ It's not clear from the sentence.

4. A group of friends had a picnic on a windy day. Which sentence correctly states what happened to their hats?
Ⓐ The friends' hats blew away.
Ⓑ The friends hats blew away.
Ⓒ The friend's hats blew away.
Ⓓ The friends hat's blew away.

Directions: In each sentence below, circle the word that is missing an apostrophe. Write the correct form of that word on the line provided. If the sentence is correct and needs no changes, write the letter *C* for correct.

_____ **5.** The puppys whimpering was breaking Marta's heart.

_____ **6.** The presidents speech was both hopeful and motivating.

_____ **7.** The hurricane did not damage many families homes too severely.

_____ **8.** Their schools mascot isn't as frightening as ours.

_____ **9.** The tour guide repeated that no one should touch the birds nests.

_____ **10.** It's too bad Shondra's brother's bike was stolen.

_____ **11.** Have you seen the pictures from Emily and Jasons trip?

_____ **12.** The yellow shovel is ours and the green one is yours.

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